



PHOTOS BY **HEMANT MISHRA**

KEY HR INITIATIVES

- **Flexible work arrangements**
- **Policies ensuring that employees find satisfaction in their work and roles**
- **Defining culture through three values: respecting the user, respecting the opportunity and respecting each other**
- **A commitment to ensuring that people realise their true potential at work**
- **Building a culture of belonging at work that is aligned with developing new products and the needs of society**

who can put in half their weekly working hours and get their complete salary during their first two weeks back at work. Not only that, Google has been ensuring pay equity for all women employees since 2017. This is done based on a statistical analysis to make sure all new salaries, bonuses and equity awards are fair. “We take into account the things that should impact pay, such as role, level, location and performance. If there are differences in the proposed pay between men and women globally, we make upward adjustments,” she explains.

Based on data from Google, 2022 was the company’s best year for women in tech and the Asia Pacific region demonstrates this. The number of woman hires was at 37.2 per cent, which is higher than the global average. For context, the share of woman hires in tech globally has increased from 20.8 per cent in 2014 to 33.7 per cent now. Similarly, women in leadership roles has

increased from 28.1 per cent in 2021 to 30.6 per cent in 2022.

The concept of flexibility is another aspect that Google pays a lot of attention to. According to Rao, the company’s hybrid approach means that staff spend around three days a week in the office and two days from wherever they work best. “We also offer opportunities for Googlers to apply for completely remote work, which is away from the team or office, based on role and team needs. Now, they can temporarily work from a location other than their main office for up to four weeks per year, with their manager’s approval,” says Rao, adding that the goal is to give everyone more flexibility around summer and holiday travels. All of this combined has helped Google India emerge as one of the top companies in the *BT*-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India ranking this year.

On the specific issue of inclusion

and LGBTQ+ policies, the thinking at the tech giant is to close the gap in the different experiences of the under-represented groups. “Every Googler is encouraged to take unconscious bias training and we are integrating diversity, equity and inclusion into our mandatory manager training. To date, over 20,000 Googlers (including 80 per cent people managers) have engaged in workshops that focus on the science of how the brain works. [This has] created a company-wide dialogue around how unconscious biases can affect one’s perceptions of others,” says Rao.

In a world that is evolving and changing rapidly, the tech major continues to be proactive. Its people are critical to the success of the organisation and Google India wants to leave no stone unturned to meet their needs. **BT**

@krishnagopalan